AS · Cambridge (CIE) · Physics

2 hours 10 questions

Structured Questions

Elastic & Plastic Behaviour

Elastic & Plastic Behaviour / Elastic Potential Energy

Easy (3 questions)	/26
Medium (5 questions)	/57
Hard (2 questions)	/27
Total Marks	**/110**

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Easy Questions

1 (a) Fig. 1.1 shows an incomplete extension–load graph obtained by adding multiple 1.0 N weights to a spring and recording the extension.

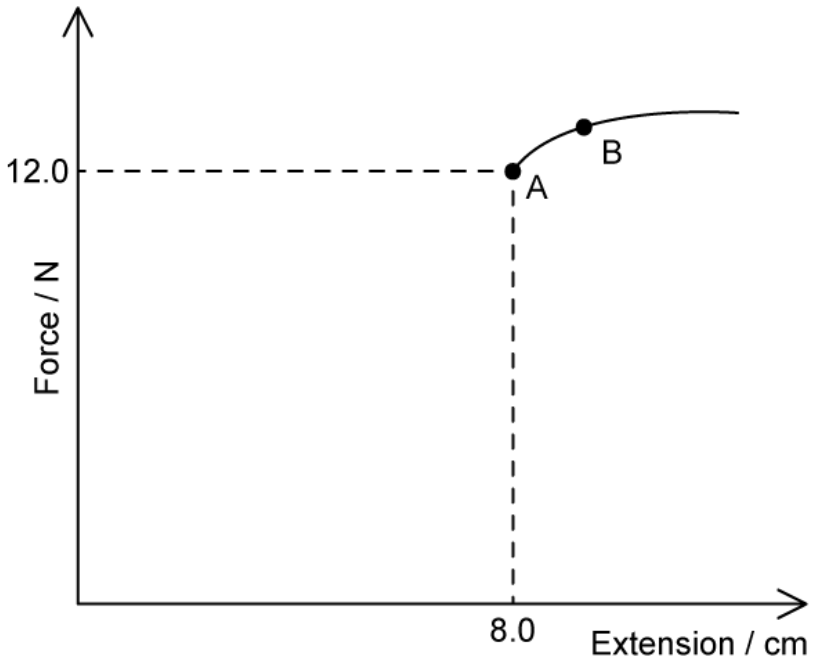


Fig. 1.1

The spring obeys Hooke's law up to point A.

Draw a suitable line on Fig. 1.1 to show the relationship between force and extension up to point A.

(2 marks)

(b) State the relevance of point A.

.....

(1 mark)

(c) Use Fig. 1.1 to calculate the energy stored in the spring when it is extended 8.0 cm. Show your working clearly.

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..... **(3 marks)**

(d) Fig. 1.1 shows the spring exhibits *elastic deformation* up to point B.

(i) State the name given to point B.

[1]

(ii) Explain what is meant by elastic deformation.

[2]

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..... **(3 marks)**

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2 (a) Define the term plastic deformation.

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(2 marks)

(b) A student applies a range of forces to a metal wire and records the extension. The force–extension graph of his results is shown Fig. 1.1.

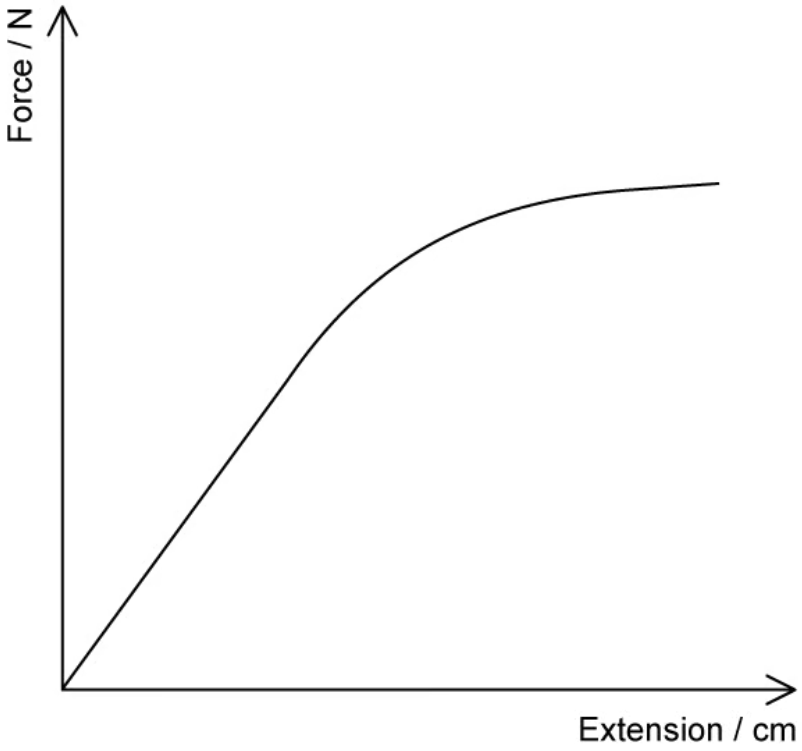


Fig. 1.1

(i) Mark the elastic limit on Fig. 1.1. Label this E.

[1]

(ii) Show clearly on the y–axis of Fig. 1.1 the range of forces which cause the wire to exhibit elastic behaviour.

[1]

(2 marks)

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(c) After the student has applied 15.0 N to the wire he reduces the force applied to it in small increments and records the extension.

On Fig. 1.2, draw a line to show how the relationship between the force acting on the wire and the extension as all the force is reduced.

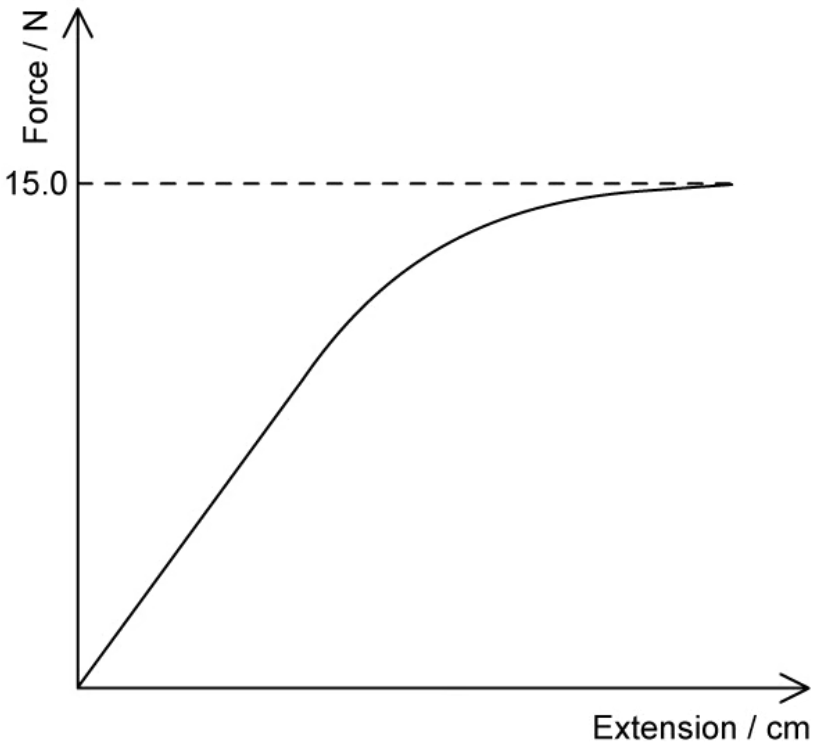


Fig. 1.2

(3 marks)

(d) Another identical spring is loaded with weights.

It has an extension of 8.0 cm and stores 24 J of elastic potential energy.

Calculate the spring constant of this spring.

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..... **(3 marks)**

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3 (a) Define

(i) stress

[1]

(ii) strain.

[1]

.....

.....

(2 marks)

(b) A student performs an experiment to determine the Young modulus of a metal wire.

State **two** measurements, other than the applied load, that are required to determine the Young modulus of the metal.

For each measurement, name a suitable measuring instrument.

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(2 marks)

(c) A force F is applied to a uniform wire. The variation with extension x of F is shown in Fig.

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4.1.

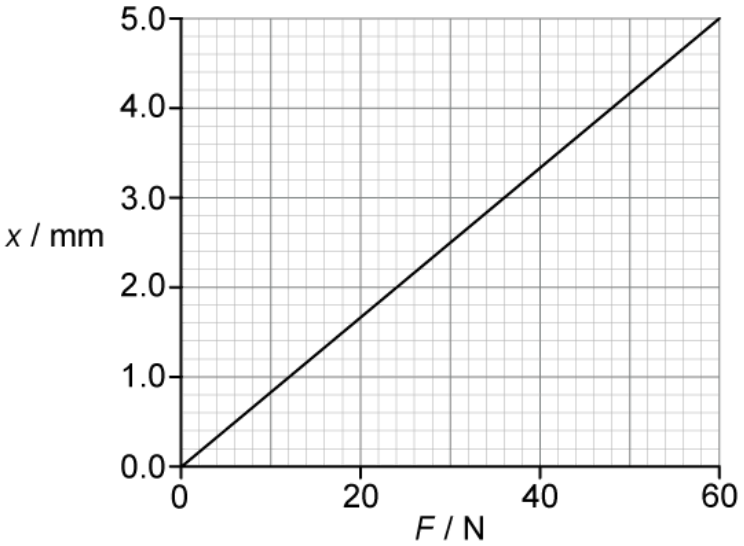


Fig. 4.1

The wire obeys Hooke's law up to a force of 60 N.

(i) Calculate the elastic potential energy stored in the wire when F = 60 N.

[2]

(ii) A force of greater than 60 N is now applied to the wire.

Describe how it may be checked that the elastic limit of the wire has not been exceeded.

[1]

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..... **(3 marks)**

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Medium Questions

1 (a) **Fig. 1.1** is a graph of stress against strain for two wires, **X** and **Y**. The wires are made from different materials but have the same dimensions.

(i) Describe, giving reasons for your answer, three properties of material **X**.

[6]

(ii) State the meaning of points F_x and F_y and explain their significance.

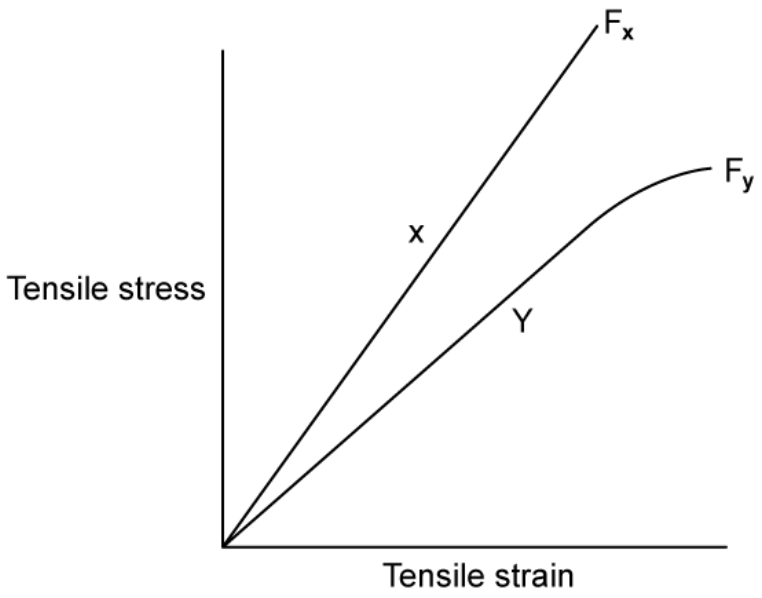


Fig. 1.1

[2]

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..... **(8 marks)**

(b) State and explain which wire would be more suitable for use as cables and structural beams.

.....

..... **(2 marks)**

(c) A group of physics students are told that they will be performing the investigation which leads to the graph in part (a).

State two safety precautions which they must take and explain your answer.

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..... **(2 marks)**

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2 (a) Fitness equipment often uses springs as a method of creating resistance. One example is the Push Down Bar, which the manufacturer says can help a person who uses it to 'increase strength and burn calories'.

To use a Push Down Bar a person applies force by pushing the handles towards each other as shown in Fig. 1.1.



Fig. 1.1

Fig. 1.2 shows the construction of the Push Down Bar.

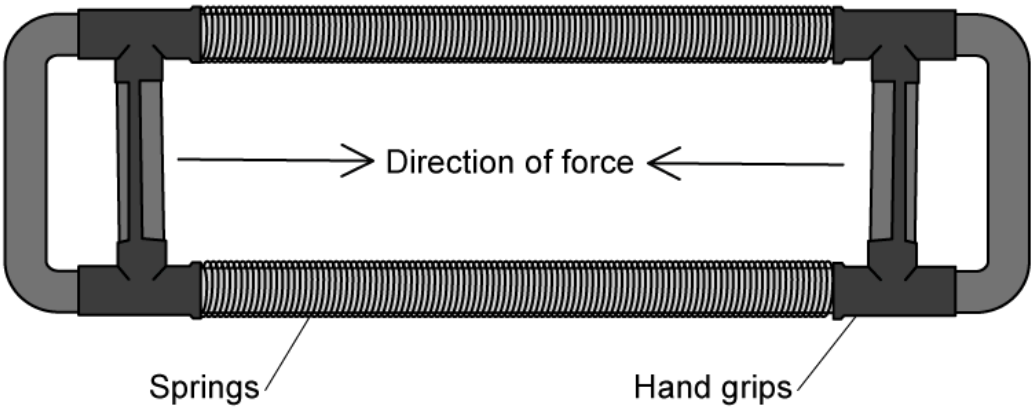


Fig. 1.2

(i) State the type of force used when exercising with this equipment.

[1]

(ii) Explain why using this equipment would help the person burn calories.

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[3]

(4 marks)

(b) The relationship between applied force and change in length of the springs was measured for a range of values of force.

The results are plotted on the graph in Fig. 1.3.

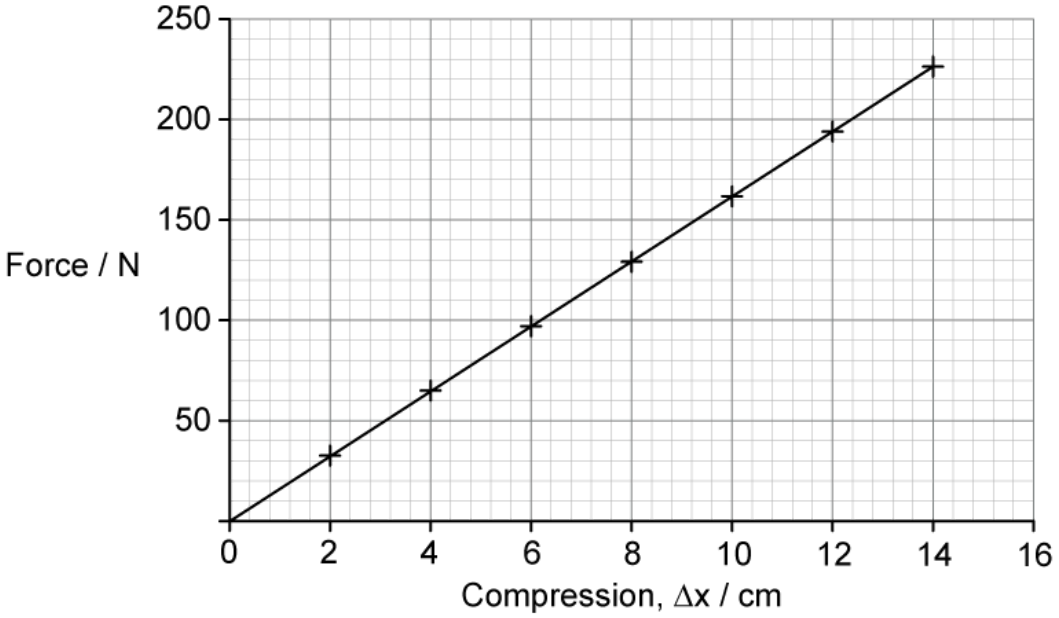


Fig. 1.3

(i) State, with a reason, whether the spring obeys Hooke's law over the range of values tested.

[2]

(ii) Use the graph in Fig. 1.3 to calculate the spring constant, stating an appropriate unit.

[3]

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(5 marks)

(c) Derive the formula for the elastic potential energy stored by the spring from the graph of force against extension.

(4 marks)

(d) State and explain whether the material chosen for the spring for the equipment in Fig. 1.1 should exhibit elastic or plastic behaviour.

(2 marks)

3 (a) A manufacturer produces springs for use in school laboratory investigations. As part of quality control the springs are spot-checked by measuring the extension produced for certain applied loads.

The graph of the testing data is shown in Fig. 1.1

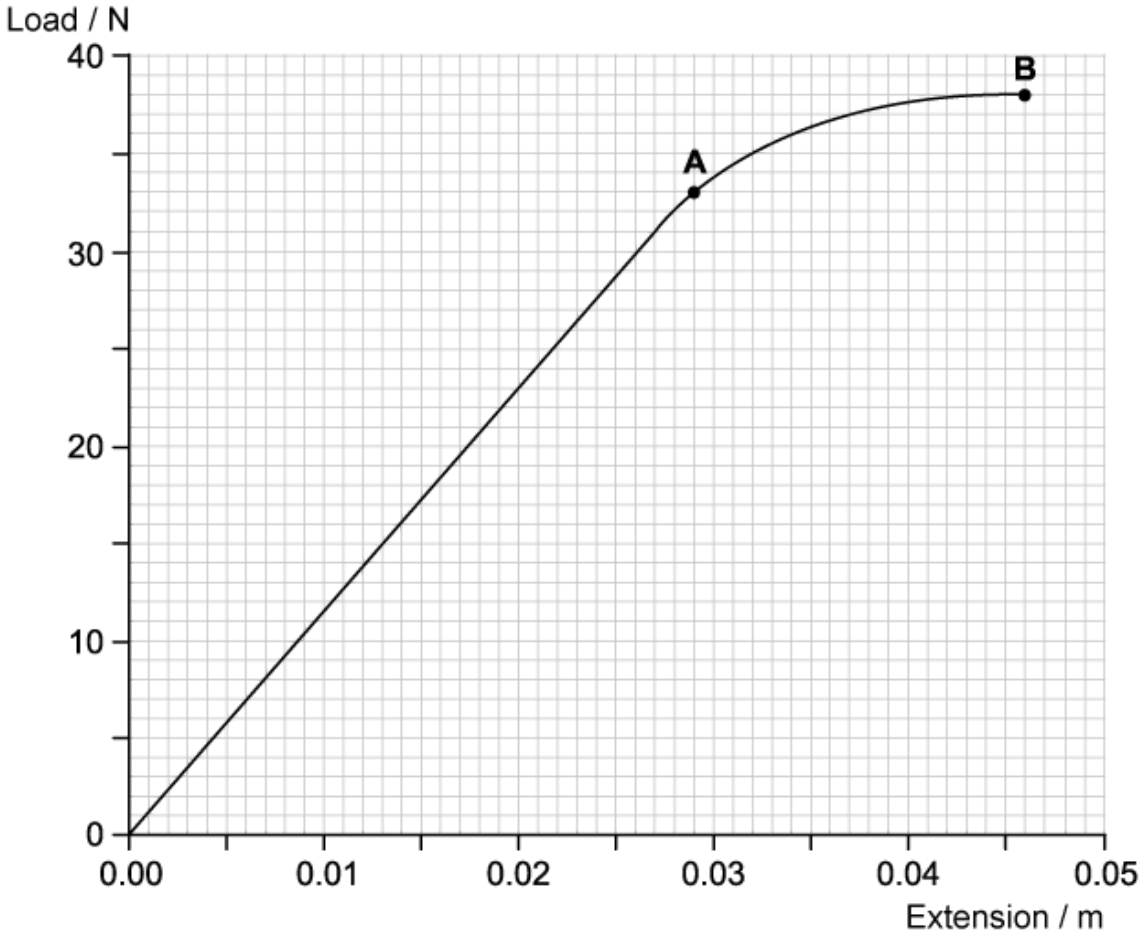


Fig. 1.1

Use a graphical method to calculate the spring constant of the spring.

Show your working.

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..... **(3 marks)**

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(b) Show that the work done in extending the spring up to point **A** is approximately 0.5 J.

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..... **(3 marks)**

(c) When the spring reaches an extension of 0.046 m, the load on it is gradually reduced to zero.

On the graph in Figure 1.1, sketch how the extension of the spring will vary with load as the load is reduced to zero.

Explain why the graph has this shape.

(3 marks)

(d) Without further calculation, compare the total work done by the spring when the load is removed with the work that was done by the load in producing the extension of 0.046 m.

Explain how this is represented on the graph drawn in part (c).

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..... **(3 marks)**

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4 (a) Materials scientists are asked to produce a material which would be suitable to use in constructing the wing of an aeroplane.

The team of scientists work with two materials, an aluminium alloy and a carbon fibre composite.

Suggest a material property which the scientists are likely to investigate and report on, and give a reason.

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..... **(2 marks)**

(b) Fig. 1.1 shows the stress-strain graph that the scientists obtain for the aluminium alloy.

They have labelled a point **Q** on the graph.

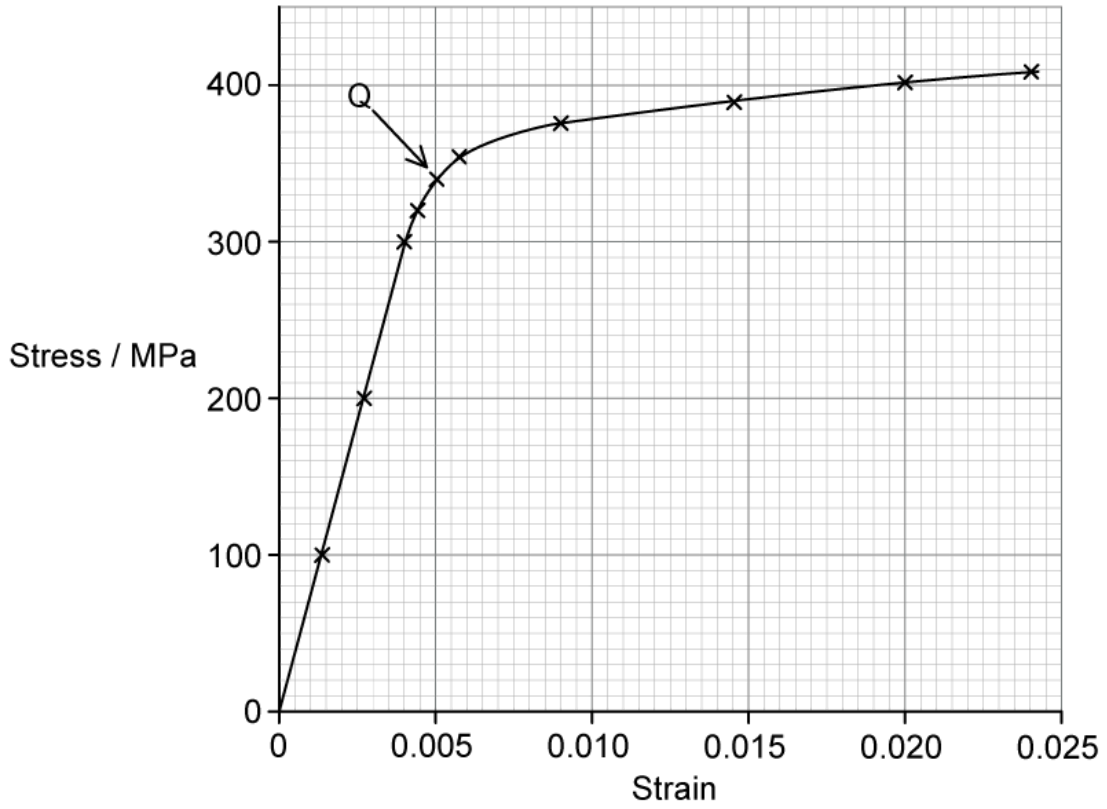


Fig. 1.1

(i) State the name of point **Q** and suggest why the scientists have drawn attention to it.

[3]

(ii) Use the graph to determine the Young modulus of the aluminium alloy. Show your working.

[3]

(6 marks)

(c) The aluminium alloy wire has a diameter of 1.2 mm. Calculate the elastic potential energy stored in the wire when it shows an extension of 7.5 cm under a total stress of 190 MPa.

(3 marks)

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5 (a) A steel bar is 40 mm long and has cross-sectional area 4.5×10^{-4} m^2.

The bar is compressed using a vice so that the length is reduced by 0.20 mm.

The Young Modulus of steel = 2.1×10^{11} Pa.

Calculate the compressive force exerted on the bar.

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..... **(2 marks)**

(b) Calculate the work done compressing the bar.

.....

..... **(2 marks)**

(c) For the compression described in part (a)

(i) Sketch a graph to show the compression, assuming that the elastic limit has not been reached.

[2]

(ii) Suggest how the elastic potential energy could be ascertained from the graph.

[1]

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..... **(3 marks)**

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Hard Questions

1 (a) A light spring of length 2.2 cm is hung from a fixed point. An object of weight 4.0 N is hung from the other end of the spring. Fig. 1.1 shows the length of the spring when the object is in equilibrium.

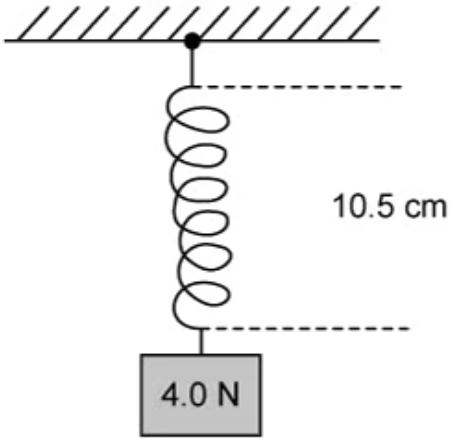


Fig. 1.1

The object is then pulled vertically downwards and is no longer in its equilibrium position. This is shown in Fig. 1.2.

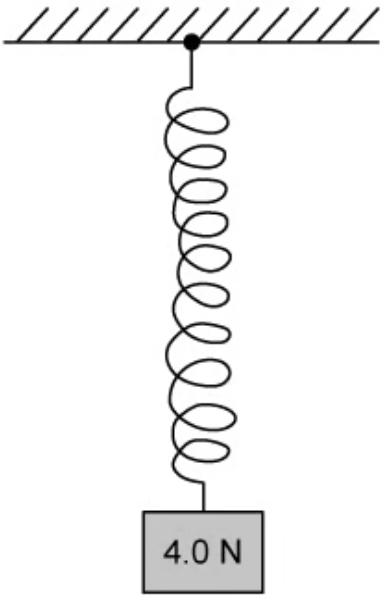


Fig. 1.2

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The change in elastic potential energy ΔE between the spring in Fig. 1.1 and Fig. 1.2 is 0.30 J.

Calculate the length of the spring in Fig. 1.2.

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..... **(4 marks)**

(b) The object is released from its position shown in Fig. 1.2.

Calculate its initial acceleration.

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..... **(3 marks)**

(c) Fig. 1.3 shows a force–extension graph for the spring.

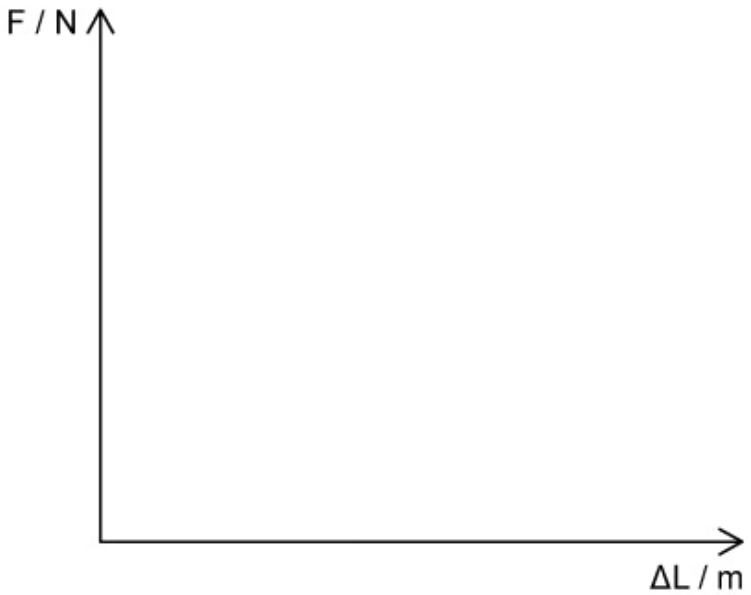


Fig. 1.3

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Assuming that the spring is not extended beyond its limit of proportionality:

(i) Sketch a graph on Fig. 1.3 to show the key values from the spring in equilibrium (in Fig. 1.1) and when the spring is extended (in Fig. 1.2).

[4]

(ii) Show that the graph also demonstrates that the change in elastic potential energy stored, ΔE is 0.30 J.

[2]

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..... **(6 marks)**

(d) Fig. 3.1 now shows two different springs S_1 and S_2 . The top ends of the springs are

attached to a rod.

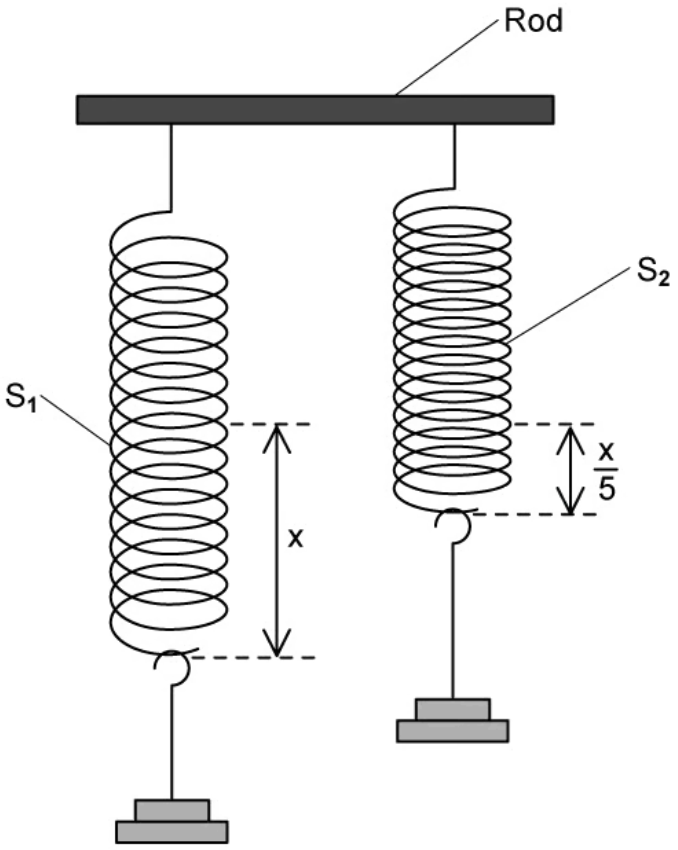


Fig. 3.1

A mass is hung from the bottom end of S_1. The extension of S_1 is *x* and the elastic potential energy in the spring is 19 mJ. The same mass is hung from the bottom end of S_2. The extension of S_2 is $\frac{x}{5}$ and its spring constant is 5 times that of S_1.

Calculate the elastic potential energy in S_2.

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..... **(3 marks)**

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2 (a) An adventure experience is shown in Fig. 1.1 below.

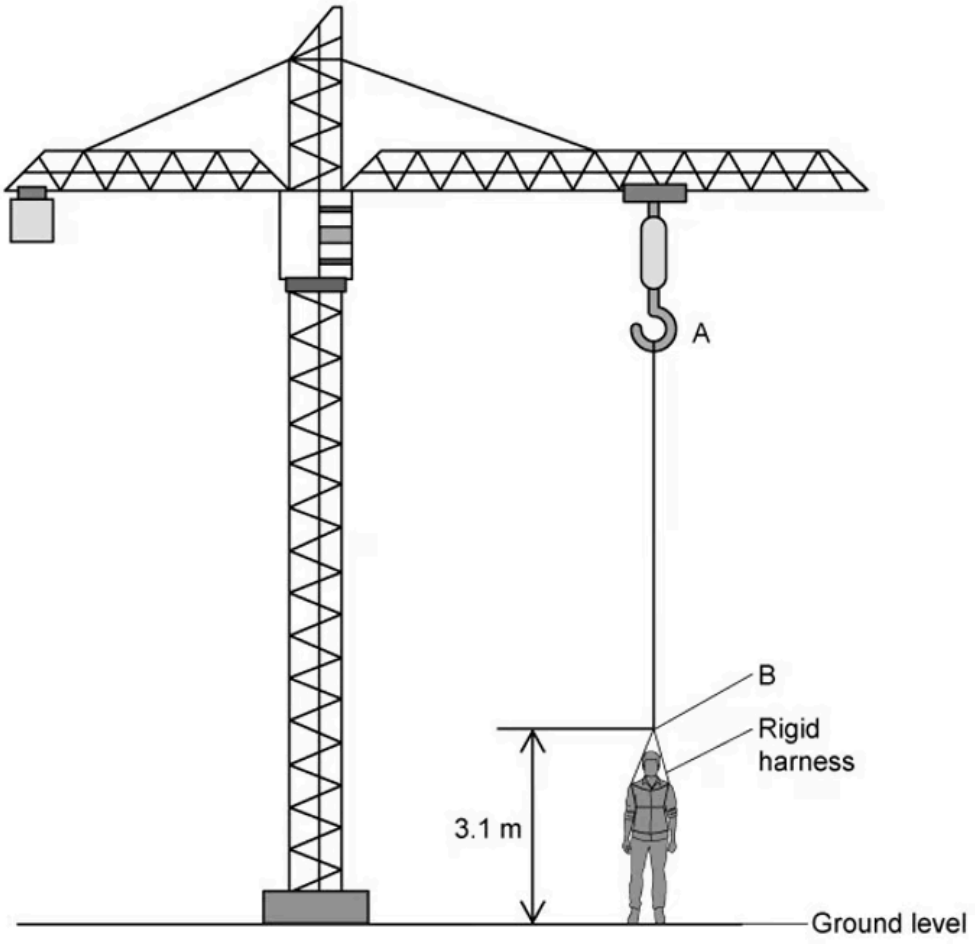


Fig. 1.1

The rider is strapped into a rigid harness attached to one end of an elastic rope AB. The rider and the rope behave in the same way as a mass–spring system.

The rope has an unstretched length of 27 m. When stretched, the rope obeys Hooke's law. The rider and harness have a total mass of 65 kg.

The rider is initially held at rest at ground level. The lower end of rope B is attached to the rigid harness at a point which is 3.1 m above the ground, so the harness doesn't injure the rider by being too close. The top end of the rope, A, is adjusted so the rope becomes unstretched when the rider is at the highest point of the ride. The rider is released and moves upwards, reaching a maximum height when the rope is at its unstretched (natural) length. The rider then oscillates vertically.

The height of point A above the ground is 51 m.

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Calculate the spring constant of the rope neglecting air resistance and ignoring the mass of the rope in this question.

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..... **(3 marks)**

(b) A different ride consists of a 15 m length of rope, stretched into a 'V' shape PQR on a frame, as shown in Fig 1.2. The frame is 16 m wide and the rider stands in the middle at position R. The ends of the elastic rope are fixed to the frame at the point P and Q.

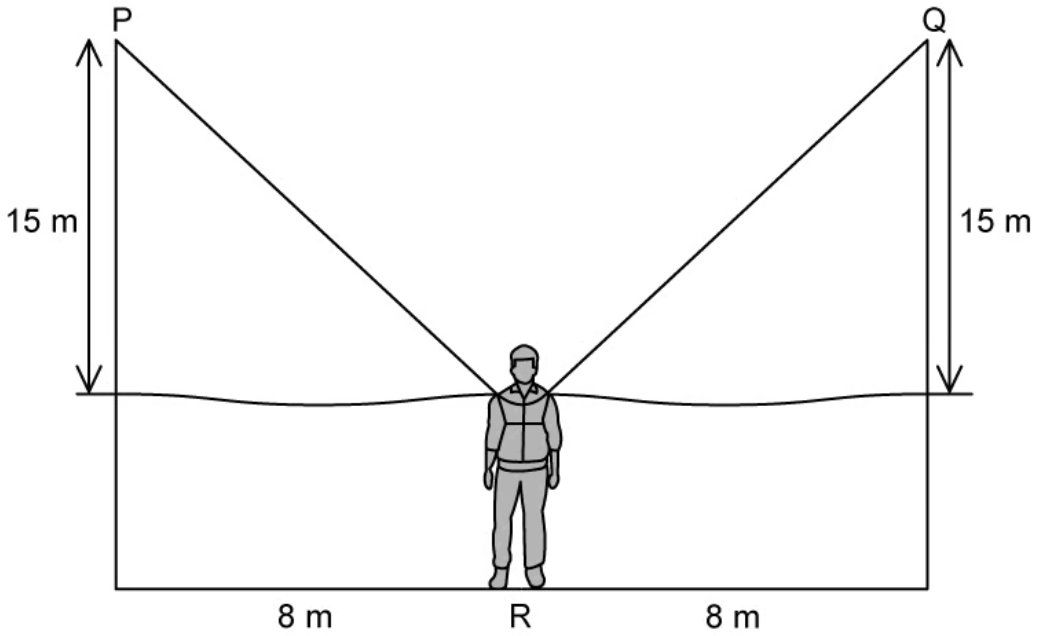


Fig. 1.2

The rider is attached to the midpoint of the elastic rope at R. The Young Modulus of the rope is 1920 Pa, and the cross-sectional area of the rope is 1 m^2.

Calculate the elastic potential energy of the elastic rope in the initial position shown in the diagram.

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(4 marks)

(c) The elastic bungee cord is replaced with an elastic which can also provide mechanical resistance when performing fitness exercises. The graph of load against extension for the chord is shown in Fig. 1.3 below.

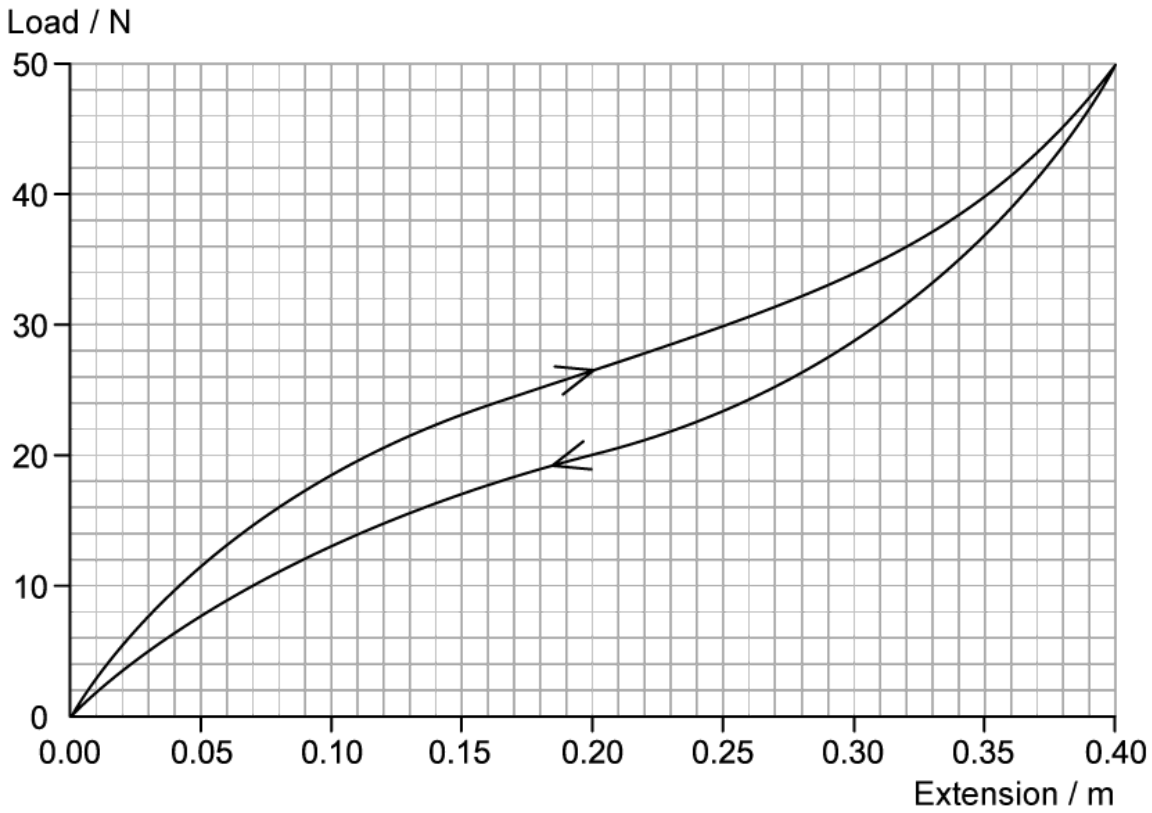


Fig. 1.3

Estimate the minimum energy required to stretch the elastic to an extension of 0.40 m.

(4 marks)

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